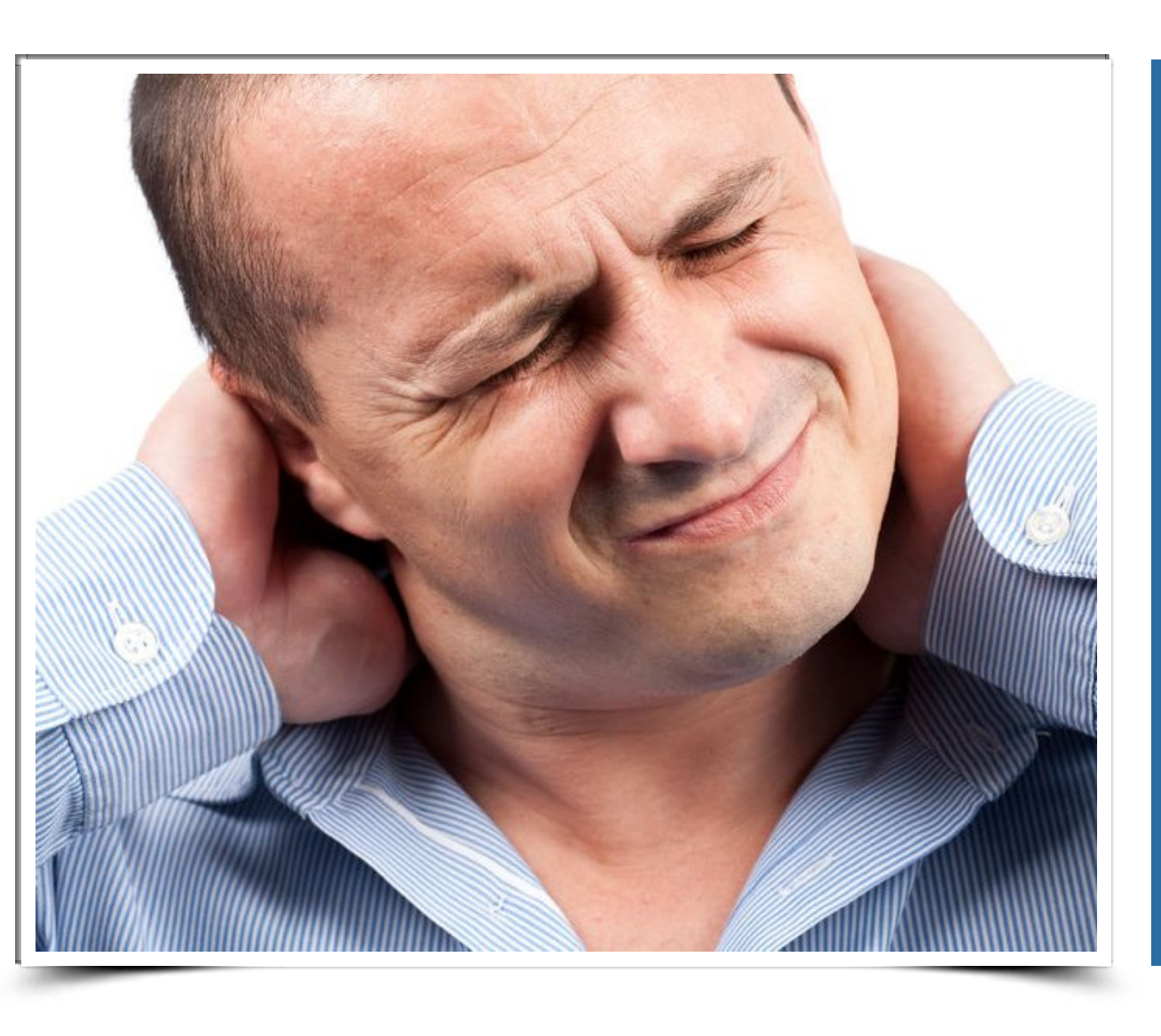
Neck Strap Roundup

A Review



About Our Reviewers

Unlike a mouthpiece or instrument, a neck strap is the one piece of equipment that can be accurately evaluated by anyone. Everyone is an expert. We have assembled over 25 saxophonists of all shapes, sizes, and levels of experience, with the intent of providing you the most accurate review of what is available for the modern saxophonist. We would like to extend our thanks to Dr. Bob Fuson, Wade Howles, Billy McPhail, Nick May, and the students of the University of Nebraska-Lincoln Saxophone studio for their assistance.

"A pain in the neck"-Finding the Right Neck Strap

complied by Paul Haar

When it comes to saxophone equipment, there isn't much unchartered territory left. If you're looking for a mouthpiece, you have hundreds of designers to consider. Ligatures? Oy veh…don't get me started. What's left? That's right: neck straps. Now there are some of you who are laughing, thinking, "It's a neck strap!" Well, my friend, you are about to learn a lot about what is out there and what you might be missing. For this review, we have assembled a panel of students and professionals, each with unique qualifications and experiences that will test the limits of these products. We were fortunate to review products from a variety of makers from around the world including:

TRADITIONAL STRAPS
- B.Air Bird Strap
- Bebop
- D'Addario
- DeJacques
- JUST JOE'S
- Manning
- Marmaduke
- NEOTECH
- Oleg
- Protec
- Ray Hyman
- Vandoren
- Yamaha

HARNESSES:
- BG
- Marmaduke Feather Strap Dual Harness
- NEOTECH
- Vandoren Harness
- B.Air Harness
- Breathtaking
- Saxholder by Jazzlab

Note: We reached out to Protec, Neotech, Dante Straps and BG to review products. Our numerous calls and emails were not returned. Any products reviewed by those companies were provided by members of our review group.

It was not our intent to endorse one strap over another. As the old saying goes, "One man's trash is another man's treasure." I mean, choosing a strap is a personal choice. It is important to note that a product that scored low in our test may still have been the ideal product for someone in that test group. We want you to do more than just choose a strap or harness. We want you to make an informed decision that will make your playing experience more enjoyable.

We rated each product based upon the following categories: Functionality, Aesthetics, Comfort, Craftsmanship/Construction and Price. Our test group was asked to sample each product and organize their thoughts and initial impressions based all the categories except PRICE. We didn't want "sticker shock" to influence the review of the product, so we didn't disclose the price of each item until they filled out a *SurveyMonkey* survey on the other four categories. Comments were left, anonymously, as part of the survey. We have organized this review according to traditional straps (those that fit around your neck) and harnesses (any product that employed belts, straps, hooks or braces around the shoulder, chest or ribs).

If you you want to read about a particular strap, without reading through the other reviews, you can link directly to that product by clicking on the name listed above. We recommend that you read about each product and then you can click **HERE** to see how they stacked up against one another. Finally, if you are not sure what to look for in a neck strap, we offer you this **GUIDE TO SELECTING A PROPER NECK STRAP**.

Traditional Straps

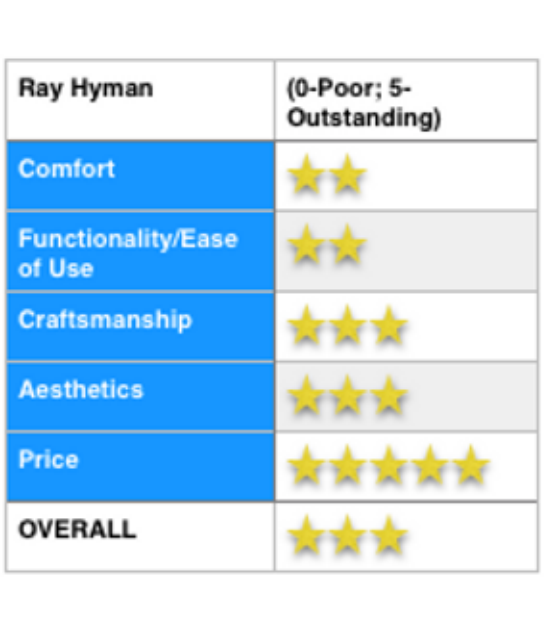
Ray Hyman

If you are the no-nonsense type who doesn't like bells and whistles, then the classic **RAY HYMAN** strap is just the thing. Offered in the thinner "slim-line" model and the thicker "sling" model, these straps are known for being durable and compact. They have durable plastic hooks that hold up well. How long will this strap last? You will probably run out of a career before you wear out a Ray Hyman.

POSITIVE COMMENTS- *"Simple, lightweight and durable." "Won't take up much room in the case." "Cheap...I can keep one with every horn."*

CRITICISMS- *"Hook doesn't lock." "In stock form, it was still too long for someone short and petite like me." "If you suffer from neck or back pain, the "slim-line" is the worst possible strap to use."*

PRICE: $12-14



Ray Hyman	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★
Craftsmanship	★★★
Aesthetics	★★★
Price	★★★★★
OVERALL	★★★

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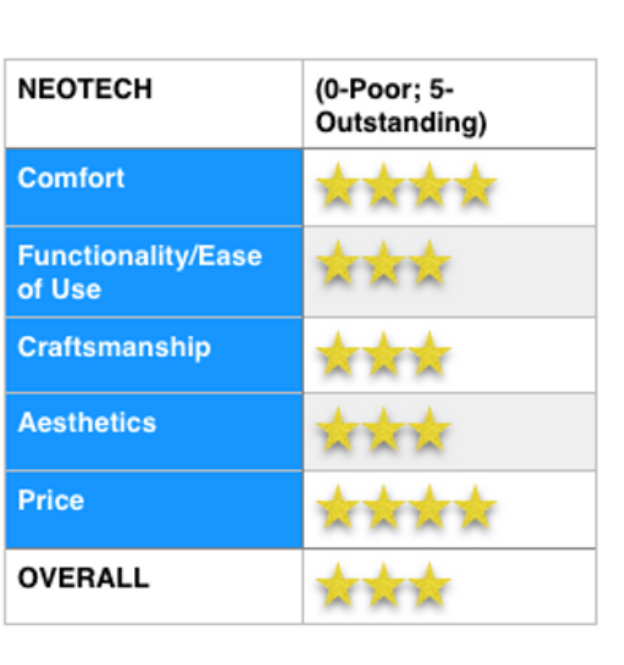
Neotech

When these neck straps came out in 1986, **NEOTECH** straps really took the playing-world by storm. Using materials like Neoprene, Lycra and elastic, they offer a strap that makes the instrument feel 50% lighter. The unique ability to stretch takes the shock and stress out of moving while playing the saxophone. That's why it's the most popular neck strap used in marching bands. They are well designed and constructed just as they were when they first came out. They are offered in a variety of colors, hook options and strap lengths. Their *Neo-Hook* system allows for interchangeable straps to be used with the same universal pad. This is welcome news for those who need a shorter strap. We reached out to **NEOTECH** to test the NEO-HOOK System but our emails were not returned. Thus, we only offer reviews of the traditional strap.

POSITIVE COMMENTS- *"They will get my Neotech when they pry it from my cold, dead hands!" "There is still nothing else that takes the stress off for marching band." "I kind of liked the bouncy/stretch!"*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS- *"Neoprene is comfortable, but hot in the sun marching." "I always have to watch that I don't push down and stretch the horn out of the right playing position." "I like it but the webbing kept getting folded and messing up the operation."*

Price: $18-26



NEOTECH	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★
Aesthetics	★★★
Price	★★★★
OVERALL	★★★

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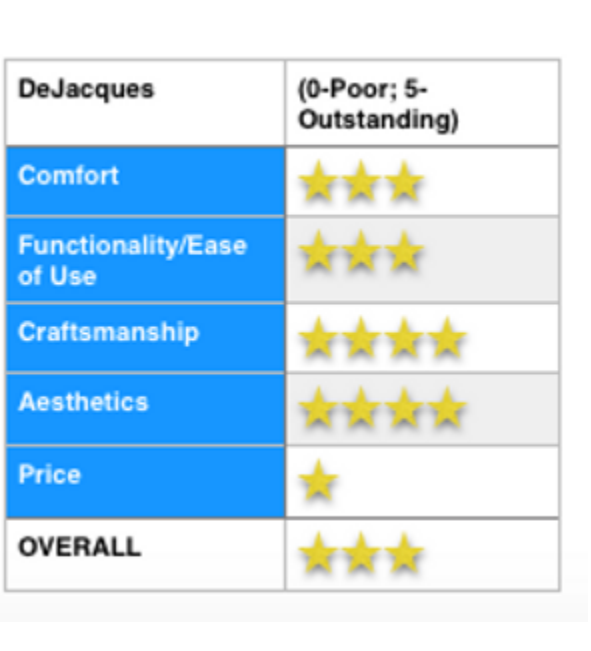
DeJacques

What can you say about the **DEJACQUES** strap? It is sturdy, supportive and has the most unique locking cam mechanism you will find. Once you get used to operating it, you can hook and unhook the saxophone in less time than a traditional hook. Some might have apprehension when they see the locking wires that hold the saxophone, but rest assured, this strap will never slip! The jaws have been tested to 125 lbs of pressure and the cords supporting the strap have been tested to hold up to 250 lbs. The cotton strap is wide enough to be comfortable, but those who have neck pain won't find a ton of stress relief. Durability of the cords is up for question. One older reviewer had owned his **DEJACQUES** for almost 15 years before the cords frayed to the point of instability. One of our younger reviewers used his strap for two years before his wore out. Have the materials changed? Operator error? Hard to say...just know it won't last forever.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"It is very easy to wear." "Once you've used it once or twice, other straps will feel cumbersome. The unique clasp is incredibly easy to take on and off, which is great for me both as a band director and someone who often has to play multiple horns on a gig." "Clasp is cool! It is so quick to put on and off!" "I like the pull. It was simple and easy to use." "It's different...a conversation piece."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"OMG $125!!! The clasp is cool but its not that cool!" "I don't know? I really liked this strap, but as a college kid on a budget I would have to choose between buying this strap or another cheaper strap and two boxes of reeds." "Will I sound better for the price?"*

PRICE: $125-130



DeJacques	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★
Aesthetics	★★★★
Price	★
OVERALL	★★★

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OUTSTANDING PRODUCT

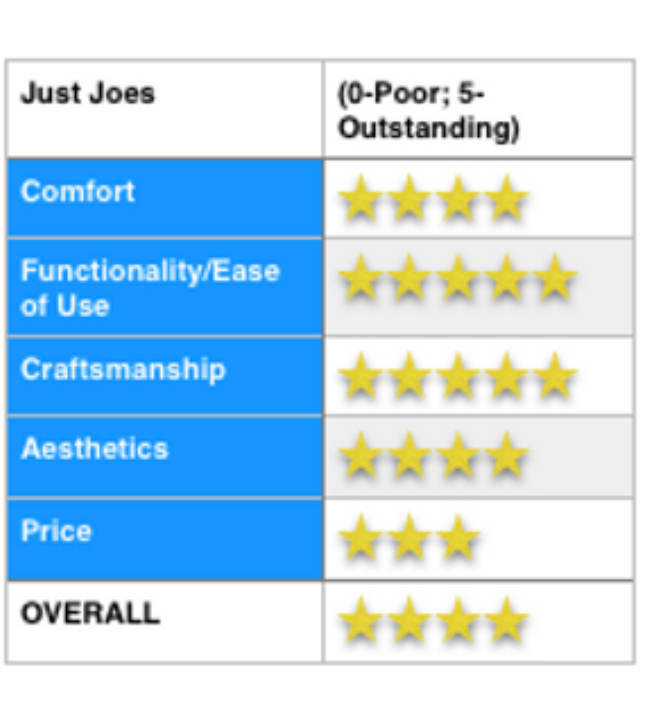
Just Joe's

Just your average Joe (Rohrbacher), of **JUST JOE'S** Sax Gel Strap, created his strap out of necessity. Having suffered from neck problems, Joe set out to create a strap to ease his pain and to allow him to resume playing. Recognizing that others could benefit from his creation, he began making and selling his straps via his music store in Bend, Oregon and via the web. Just Joe's offers a product made with premium soft leather, aircraft grade anodized aluminum sliders, industrial grade eyelets and crimps as well as a medical grade medical polymer (aka GEL) that is used as the main ingredient in the Gel Strap. Available with a variety of hook options (metal, thermoplastic, J hook) and strap lengths (19-27'' as well as custom lengths) this is a quality product with a purpose. If you are someone who suffer's from neck & back pain or just someone who enjoys a quality piece of equipment, you need to check out JUST JOE'S!

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"I don't know who first designed the "cut out" design, but it's clear that JUST JOE'S takes it to another level!" "You can just tell, compared to the other straps, that this strap is just a step above the others." "The gel is so comfortable, the materials are so well designed and stitched...it's awesome!" "I thought this strap looked just like the Pro-Tec strap...so I wondered why the price difference? Then I compared them...JOE'S is so soft and comfortable...it's so much better! Ordering one today!"*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"I don't know that I need to spend $80 for a strap. But if I needed one to ease pain or discomfort, this would be worth it."*

PRICE: $79 (regardless of length)



Just Joes	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★★
Aesthetics	★★★★
Price	★★★
OVERALL	★★★★

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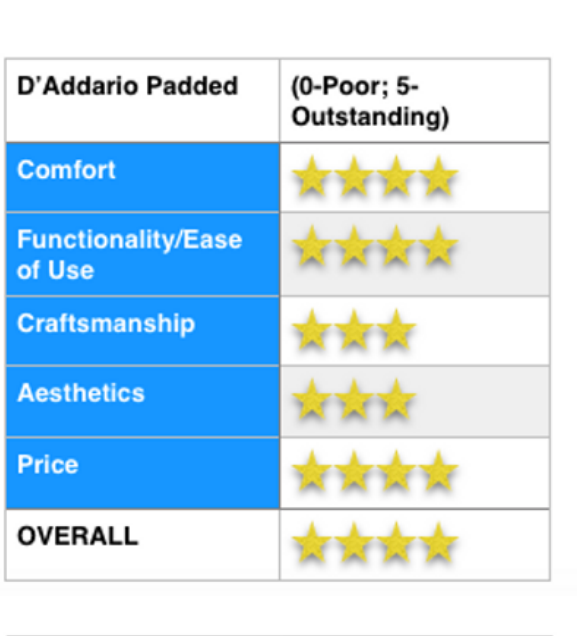
D'Addario

"A rose by another name would smell as sweet.." Shakespeare aside, you may not know the old RICO company has a new name: **D'Addario**. D'Addario offers more than just reeds, they offer a full line of products for the saxophonist. We tested two straps including the padded (above left) and the traditional (above right). Offering sizes for soprano/alto and tenor/baritone as well as a variety of hook options, D'Addario offers players two quality and affordable options.

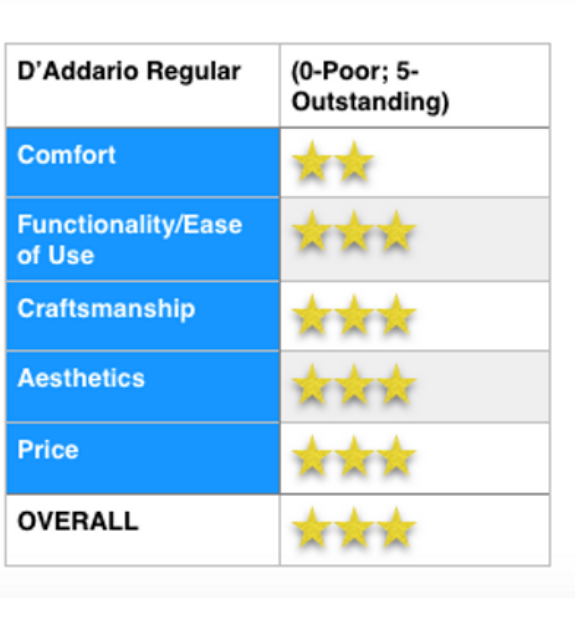
POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"The padded strap has the most comfortable neck padding of any strap I tried." "The soft microfiber material feels very comfortable and breathes well." "Cords, hooks and sliders were solid on both straps." "As someone who loses straps constantly, this would be a good choice...quality and affordable."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"Nylon strap material isn't very comfortable while playing. I normally like less padding but this is kind of thin and digs into my skin a bit." "The safety hook is awkward to use...would rather have one with the clasp." "Clasp on the regular strap always slipped...especially with a heavier horn."*

PRICE: $15-25



D'Addario Padded	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★
Aesthetics	★★★
Price	★★★★
OVERALL	★★★★



D'Addario Regular	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★
Aesthetics	★★★
Price	★★★
OVERALL	★★★

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OUTSTANDING PRODUCT

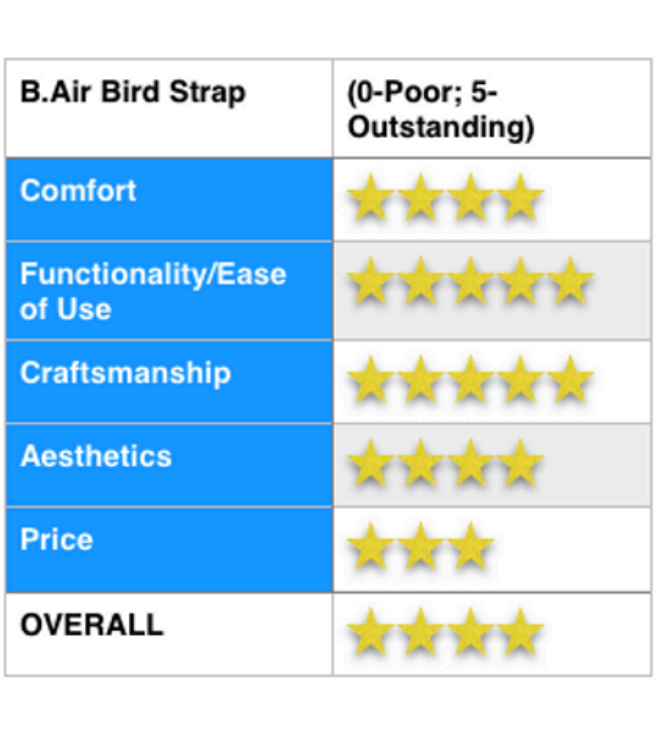
B.Air-Bird

The "Bird" neck strap from the Japanese maker **B.Air** was one of the more popular straps we tried. Offing a unique V-shaped adjustment bar (in various colors, materials and sizes) and leather pads (standard, light and slim, also in a variety of colors) this strap offers the saxophonist a comfortable way to hold the saxophone. The v-shaped adjusters come in two sizes to keep the strap from binding around the neck. The strap can be lengthened or shortened via a locking braid clinch, and the leather neck piece is offered in a choice of ortho-friendly split padding, solid padding or no padding.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"The yoke really distributes the weight niceley. Both large and extra large were very comfortable on my large frame and worked well on all saxophones." "I LOVE how it took the weight and distributed it. It didn't hug my neck like most straps do...I really like the freedom." "The y-slider is so easy to adjust...probably the easiest adjustment I've ever made with a strap." "I like the details...the cord is thick, the hook has plastic tubing (they provide extra) to protect the horn, it has a small wrench for adjustments...really well made." "The price is high but it is worth every penny to feel like this."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: Aside from the price being a bit high for some, there was nothing we could agree upon.

PRICE: Approx. $90-100



B.Air Bird Strap	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★★
Aesthetics	★★★★
Price	★★★
OVERALL	★★★★

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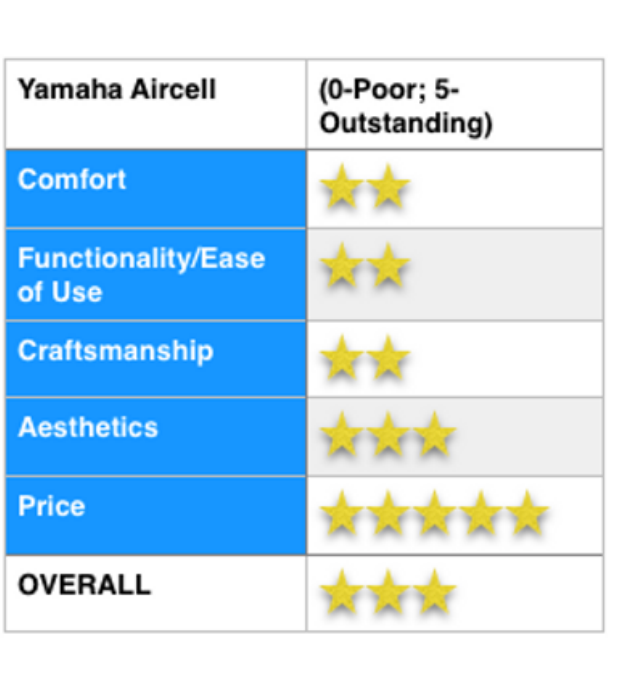
Yamaha Air Cell

The Air Cell Neck Strap is **Yamaha's** latest strap using the patented Air Cell technology. By trapping air with a specialized material that offers flexibility and cushion, Air Cell strap technology delivers maximum comfort for lasting performance. It features slip-resistant air-cushions and a rubber-covered hook that prevents scratching of the instrument.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"It was light." "It is easy to adjust and set up." "The padded section is really cool." "Nice and minimalistic...not 'in your face'"*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"The air pockets can be very uncomfortable against the bare skin." "The air cells do more to poke into your neck then they do to help create comfort." "Couldn't use with anything bigger than an alto...the strap just slid down." "The materials feel cheap as does the hook...no way my horn is getting attached to this thing."*

PRICE: $16



Yamaha Aircell	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★
Craftsmanship	★★
Aesthetics	★★★
Price	★★★★★
OVERALL	★★★

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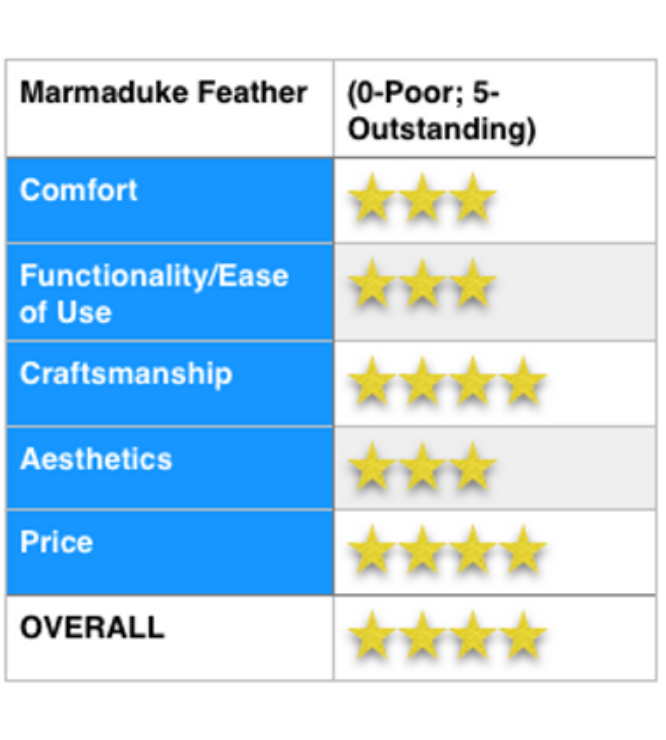
Marmaduke "Feather"

The **Marmaduke** Feather strap looks like a strap but distributes the weight over the shoulders like a harness. Utilizing moldable metal stays (covered in fine leather) and adjustable elastic cords, the strap can be adjusted to fit just about anyone. The unique knotting system allows for the strap cord to be shortened or lengthen to fit the size of user. Metal hooks and pull compliment the quality materials used in its construction. When folded the strap can fit down the bell of the saxophone.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"It took some getting used to, but I like how the weight is taken off the neck. It didn't choke me like some other straps." "LOOOOVED the slider adjustment for moving the horn up and down. WORKED GREAT!" "Very well made!" "The leather touches are very classy." "Considering the materials used, the price was very affordable."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"I didn't like how the metal stays pinched my collar bone." "It was a bit awkward to put on and get it to stay in place." "I felt like it would be better for bigger horns." "I don't have the patience to fit those metal rods to my body."*

PRICE: Approx. $68



Marmaduke Feather	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★
Aesthetics	★★★
Price	★★★★
OVERALL	★★★★

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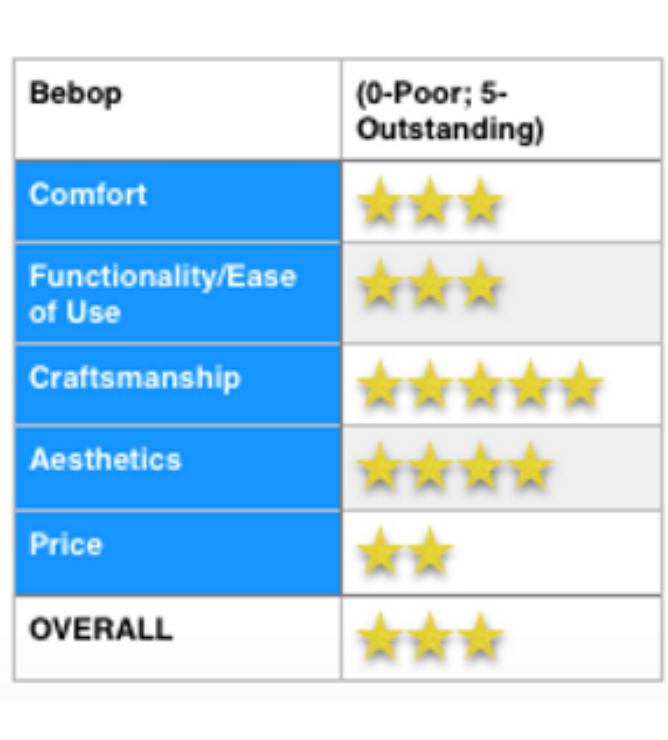
Bebop

If you live by the statement, "They don't make 'em like they used to" then the **BEBOP** neck strap is the answer to your prayers! Harkening back to the classic leather straps offered by Buescher, Selmer and Conn, the BEBOP neck strap (made in Germany) goes a step further being constructed of Elk Leather. Being both supple and strong this strap offers a comfortable padded neck piece and quality brass hardware. Included is an additional plastic hook for those who don't wish to have metal touching their instrument. The belt-like construction ensures the proper placement with no movement.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"Better and more classy than an ordinary strap." "If you want it to stay in place and you want it to last...this will do both." "Something about the leather just sets it apart from the others." "Strap is definitely designed to high standards." "It is beautiful to look at. The leather pops and is classy."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"If you need to adjust it for different instruments it may cause some issues." "For genuine leather it is a steal...for those who don't realize that, they will think it is too expensive for what you get." "It is just a leather strap."*

PRICE: Approx. $89



Bebop	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★★
Aesthetics	★★★★
Price	★★
OVERALL	★★★

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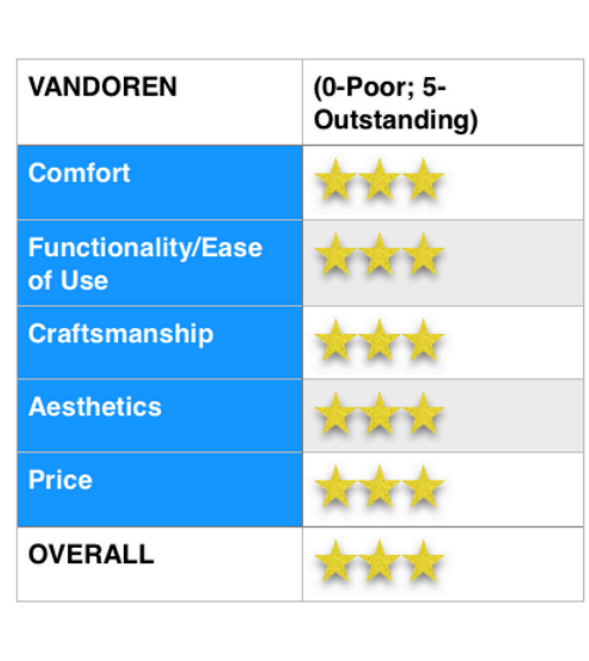
Vandoren

The **Vandoren** neck strap is ergonomically designed to provide the greatest amount of support without creating stress and fatigue to the neck and back. Wide, smooth leather and microfiber neck pad, reinforced with a silicone and shaped memory foam protection piece, optimizes the comfort allowing the player to perform without pain. Available in three sizes (S, M/L, XL) with easy adjustment mechanism and secure hook connection for easy-on/easy-off.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"I liked the hook. It looked complicated but it was very easy to use and didn't slip." "I thought it felt comfortable..relieved stress."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"Looks good but the materials are not the highest quality for the price." "I'm sorry...if you are Vandoren, you are already one of the most recognized and trusted names in woodwind playing...YOU DON'T NEED THE GIANT V LOGO!!!" "The V logo is a bit over the top and it makes it hard to adjust." "This would be a great strap for my friend **V**alerie or **V**ictor...for me...not so much."*

PRICE: Approx. $65



VANDOREN	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★
Aesthetics	★★★
Price	★★★
OVERALL	★★★

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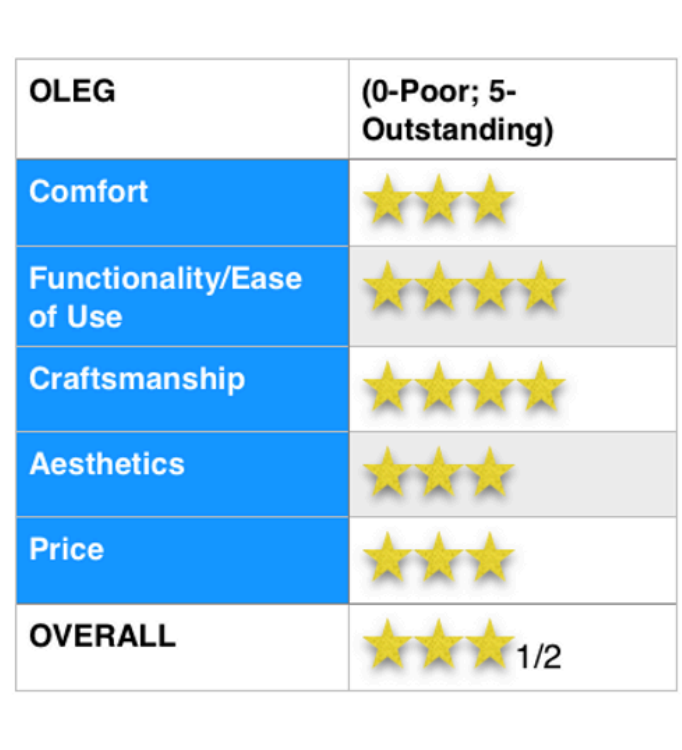
Oleg

"Designed to alleviate pressure-caused discomforts of conventional straps, the **Oleg** Ergonomic strap features a recessed neck cushion, smooth action sliders and an easy release hook. Each strap is handmade to perfection using the finest genuine American Leather. Our designer metal slider works without any mechanical clips, springs, or levers, and instead uses a sophisticated knot system to ensure secure positioning with zero risk of slipping. The strap-ring clip is made of ultra-strong, heavy-duty plastic and has proven to withstand 60+ pounds of sustained force while simultaneously protecting your instrument from scuffs and scratches."-Oleg Products

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"Although it doesn't have padding the leather is soft and the cut-out shape does add to the comfort." "The slider works well and is stylish." "The clasp is very strong for being plastic." "I love the look and feel of the strap." "Nice leather...very well made."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"Pretty pricey for no padding." "It cost a lot."*

PRICE: Approx. $90



OLEG	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★
Aesthetics	★★★
Price	★★★
OVERALL	★★★1/2

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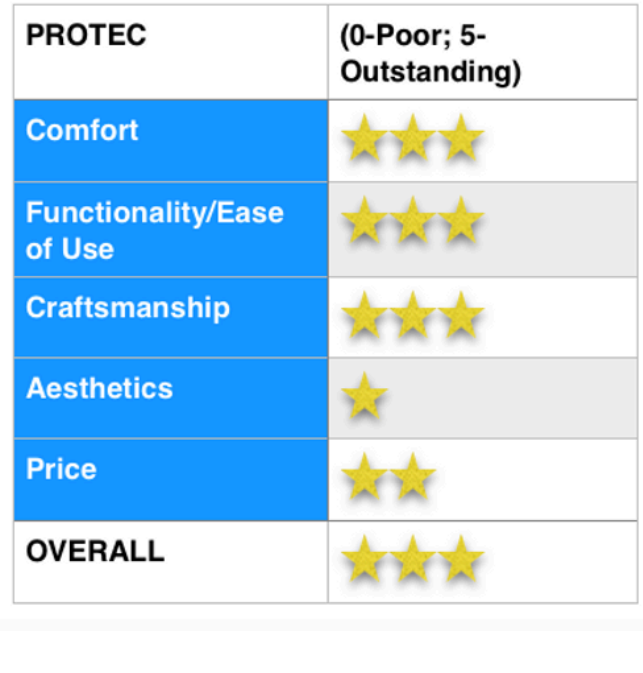
Protec

"**Protec's** Baritone/Tenor/Alto Leather "Less Stress" Neck Straps are comprised of high grade leather and have separate neck pads to reduce pressure to the middle spine. EZ grab metal slider allows for effortless length adjustment, while a rubber sleeve on the sturdy metal trigger swivel snap gently secures the strap to your horn."-Protec.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"Looks nice. Leather is a nice touch." "Does move the weight off the spine." "Slider works well."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"I am sorry but this is a "Just Joe's" knock off. The padding isn't close to Joe's but everything else looks very "familiar." "The cord is thin and cheap in quality...no way my bari is attached to this thing." "It looked great but when you take a closer look it is made with cheaper options than another straps they are obviously copying." "Which came first...the chicken or the egg? More like, which came first...Just Joes or Protec?" "Come on man...you offer this in a knockoff of a Just Joes strap or a knock off of a B.Air Bird Strap...not cool man!"*

PRICE: Approx. $52



PROTEC	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★
Aesthetics	★
Price	★★
OVERALL	★★★

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OUTSTANDING PRODUCT

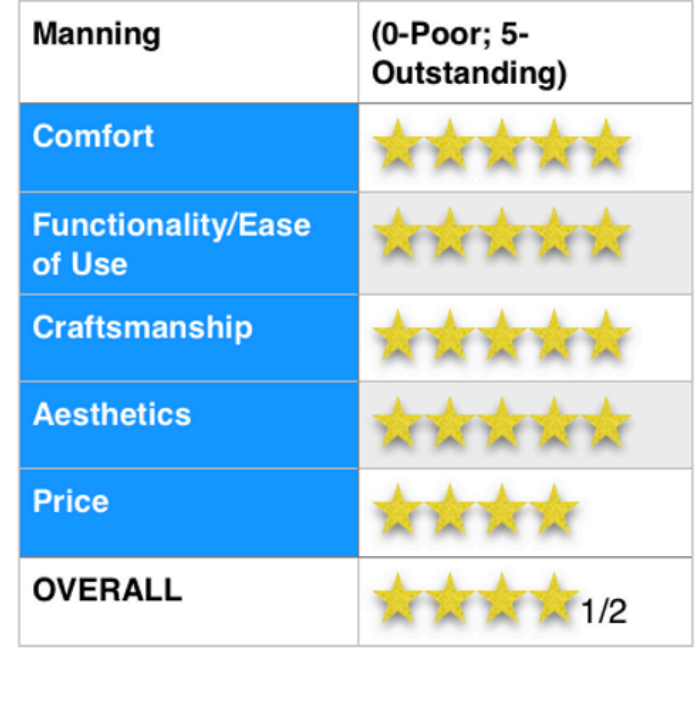
Manning

Manning Custom Woodwinds Inc. carries in-house neck straps made to the highest standards of quality. Not only are their neck straps functional and beautiful, but they will change the way your instrument sounds. Crazy? They say so. You can choose between a medium and large brass clip-hook. These hooks will not come open during use. They also use professional grade paracord that will not break or fray. The strapping is made from military grade suede. Comes with a lifetime warranty.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"This has NO padding and has webbing that is about the same size as the DeJacques...but it is the most comfortable strap I played!" "Dang dude...everything about this strap is high quality. Love the brass/bronze (I can't tell) hardware." "Ok..the strap will affect your sound? I will be darned if I couldn't tell. It is not going to make a bad player good, but you can feel the improved vibration...especially with the large hook...crazy!" "One of the best pulls I have used. Slides easily and DOES. NOT. MOVE!" "Beautiful!" "I was going to hammer it on price...but looking at it, the way it feels in your hand and how it feels to use...it is worth it."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: None we could agree on.

PRICE: Approx. $90



Manning	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★★
Aesthetics	★★★★★
Price	★★★★
OVERALL	★★★★1/2

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Harnesses

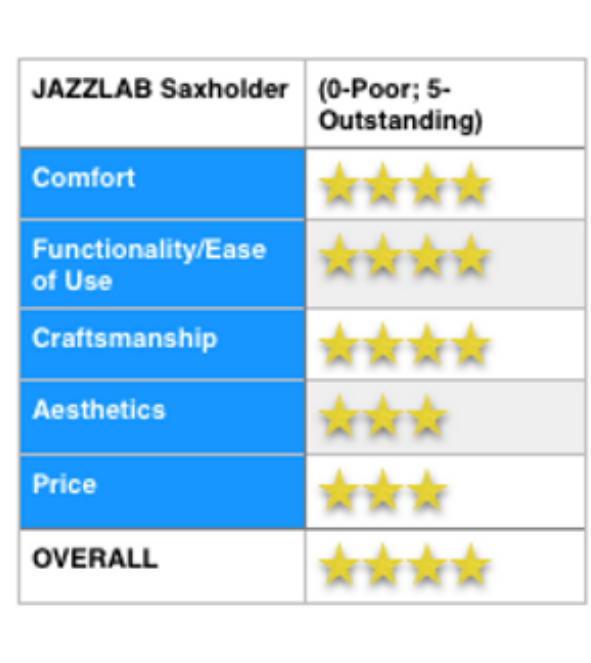
Sax holder by Jazzlab

"Typically the traditional saxophone strap or sax harness transfers the whole weight (or partial weight) of the instrument to the neck. By the time many performers complain of chronic neck pain, there may be damage to the cervical spine. **SaXholder** is a new, patented three-point support system for saxophonist where whole weight of the saxophone is transferred onto the two padded shoulder handles with assistance from the abdominal rest. Made from Kevlar and Aircraft aluminum making this harness durable and light."-JazzLab

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"Very cool design and breaks down to fit into case. I love it!!" "It is made with sturdy material and solidly made." "It's probably the most functional if you're having neck or back problems." "Love the carbon fibre...light and strong." "I think it does a great job of taking the weight away from the neck."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"Too clunky to carry around everywhere and I feel like it could re-adjust on my body if I moved around too much." "Not too conspicuous but doesn't work well with a tie...if caught underneath it slips." "It distributes the weight of the sax around your shoulders instead of on your neck, making it a perfect choice for altos, sopranos, and tenors. BARIS CAN NOT USE THIS however, as it will add too much tension and hurt."*

PRICE: Approx. $90-100



JAZZLAB Saxholder	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★
Aesthetics	★★★
Price	★★★
OVERALL	★★★★

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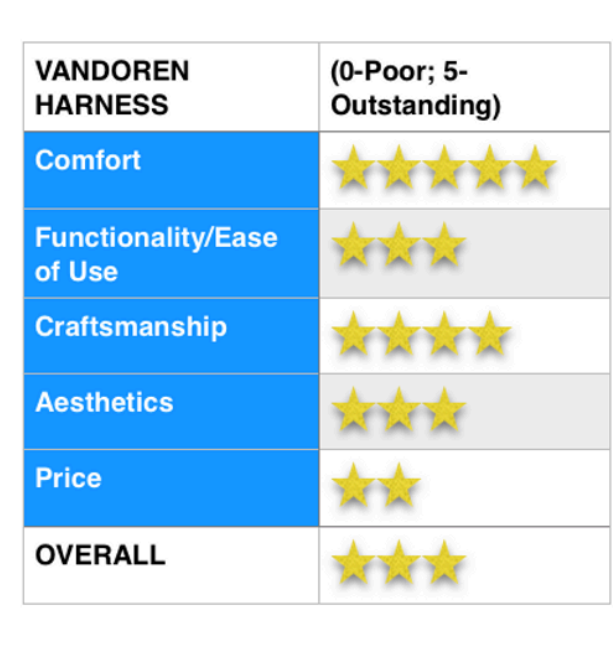
Vandoren Universal Harness

Vandoren states, "This is the first harness that makes even heavy instruments feel weightless. Its ergonomic design moves as the musician moves: in perfect harmony, to make playing easier than ever before. With the Vandoren universal harness, there is no more strain on the cervical vertebrae and breathing is left totally free. Suitable for any saxophone, and can be sized to fit children and adults." The weight of the instrument is transferred to an adjustable "spine" that attaches to the player via a waist belt. The entire unit collapses and can be kept in a neoprene pouch (included).

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"I couldn't even tell I was holding a baritone saxophone." "It was easy to put on, unlike other harnesses which you have to detangle/figure out the front from the back before you can put it on." "This looks like something batman would own if he was playing saxophone" (We took that as a compliment.) "It is a very classy looking harness. The Vandoren logo adds a nice touch." "Best body harness out of them all. Kept horn up and comfortable, and I had much more "free motion" of the horn available to me than with a traditional neck strap." "Hook is A+"*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"Not the most friendly when wearing a suit jacket or when sitting in a chair." "It looks like a robotic spine prosthetic. Plus the giant V on the chest is awful." "The only real problem is the "V" slider that adjusts the height. It was difficult to use, and looks downright ugly." "The only issue is that you can't adjust the shoulder width with it while it's on."*

PRICE: Approx. $150



VANDOREN HARNESS	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★
Aesthetics	★★★
Price	★★
OVERALL	★★★

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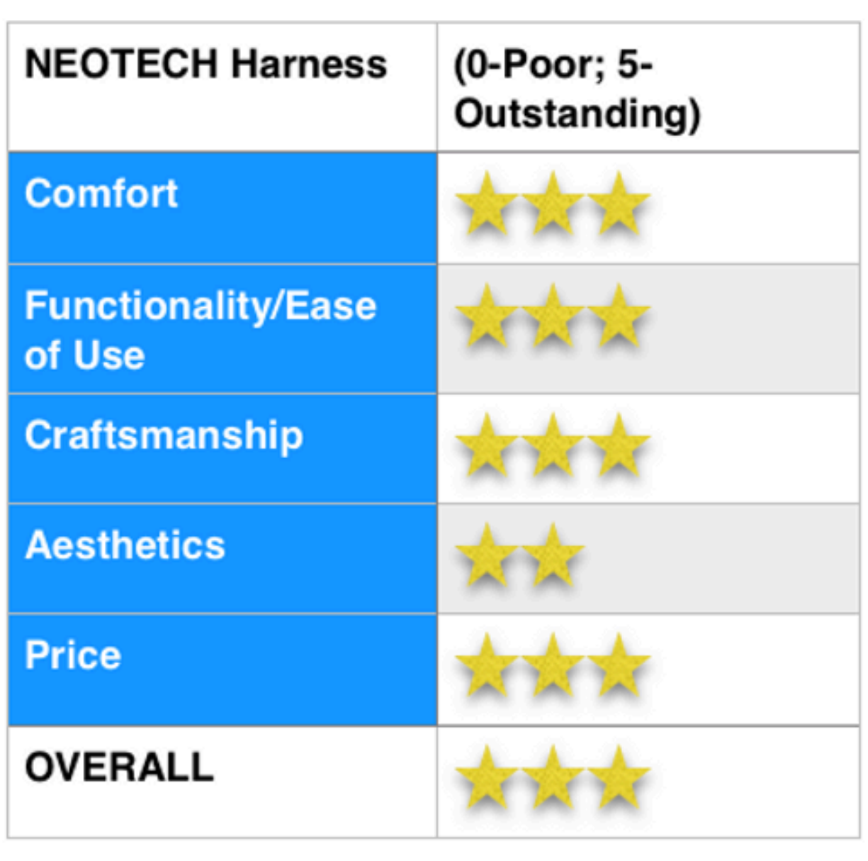
NEOTECH "SUPER HARNESS"

Offering the same materials and technology used in their popular neck straps, **Neotech** offers the "Super Harness" as an even greater way to remove the weight of the instrument. Like all Neotech products it is offered in a variety of colors.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"The Neotech harness is comfortable for the bigger saxophones. It's more of a necessity than a luxury." "The Neotech harness worked very well on baritone." "With a wide range of available colors, it's easy to find one you enjoy." "If you like this type of strap the price is right."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"Speaking from experience, it's difficult to find a comfortable position for both the harness and the saxophone to sit comfortably." "I kept having to adjust it and I felt like I couldn't get a full breath." "I felt like I could never get the strap pulled up enough. When I did the whole unit would slip forward." "It looks like a bra...I am sorry...but it does."*

PRICE: Approx. $30



NEOTECH Harness	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★
Aesthetics	★★
Price	★★★
OVERALL	★★★

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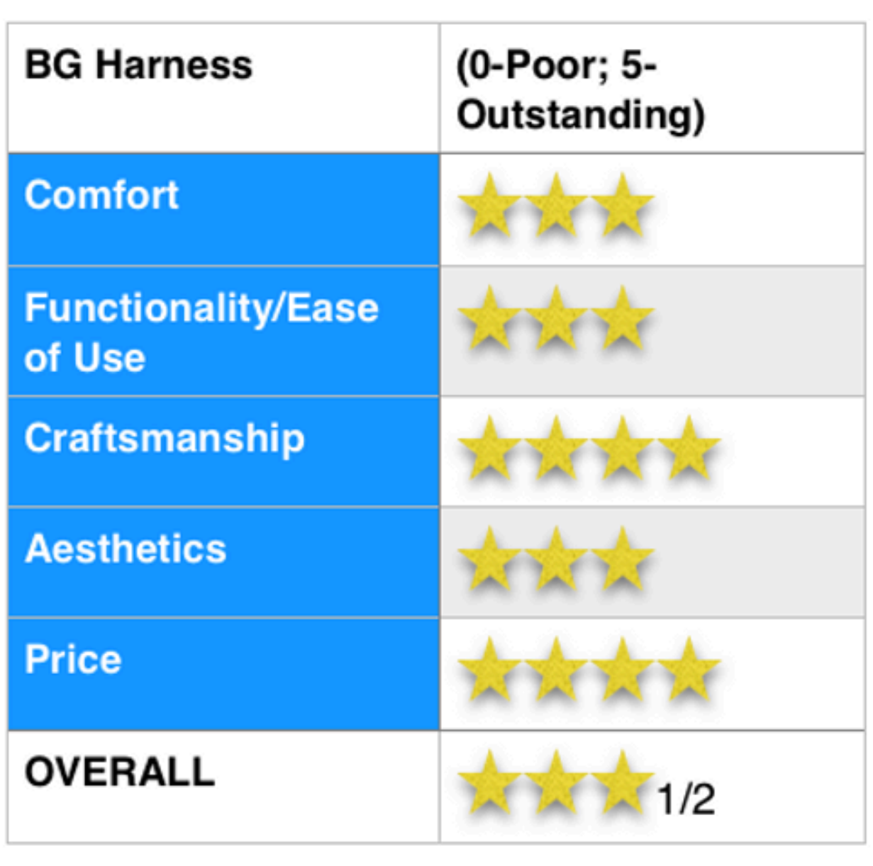
BG HARNESS

Designed for added comfort, the **BG Sax Harness** distributes the instrument's weight over both shoulders and not the neck. Comfortably holds even the largest of saxophones. Plastic clasp hook holds instrument securely even during the most demanding visual program.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"The weight of the larger saxophone sits evenly distributed across my shoulders and upper back. I've used it for both baritone and bass and had great success." "Quality materials." "Price is reasonable."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: "*Like the Neotech it was like wearing an appliance and it was hard to get a good breath." "Tenor and alto are not easy to use with this strap."*

PRICE: Approx. $35



BG Harness	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★
Aesthetics	★★★
Price	★★★★
OVERALL	★★★1/2

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OUTSTANDING PRODUCT

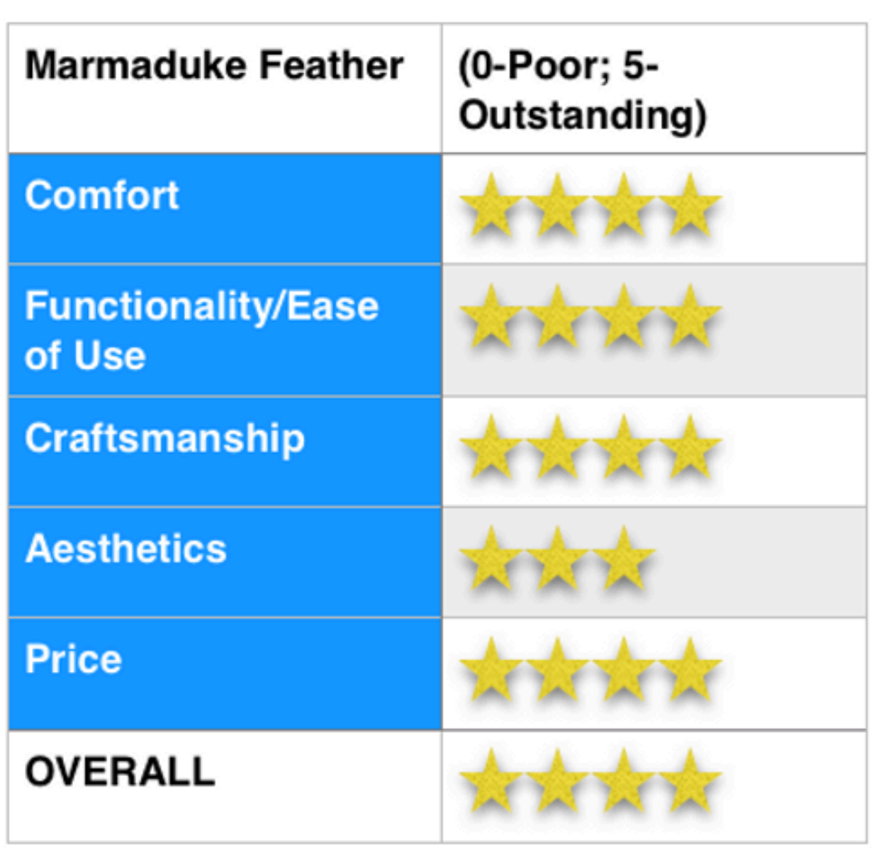
MARMADUKE FEATHER STRAP "DUAL"

The **Marmaduke** Feather Strap "DUAL" can be both a neck strap and a harness if using the optional straps. As a harness, you may use side straps to remove weight from your neck. The side straps are to be tied to the front hook or belt loops (check if your belt loops are strong enough). The neck pad has gel cushions for comfort as well as "Y" yolk to keep the strap from choking the player.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"I love this harness. It makes my alto completely weightless." "I liked this one a lot, it felt like the Vandoren harness, couldn't feel the weight of my horn at all." "The slider was super nice as well as the hook." "You can tell this company works hard to use high quality materials." "I love that it's 100% black and it would look nice for a concert." "It's cute and not bulky. It looked professional."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"The slider is a breeze to use but adjustments outside that are a chore and the whole thing was very confusing to put on."*

PRICE: Approx. $88



Marmaduke Feather	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★
Aesthetics	★★★
Price	★★★★
OVERALL	★★★★

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OUTSTANDING PRODUCT

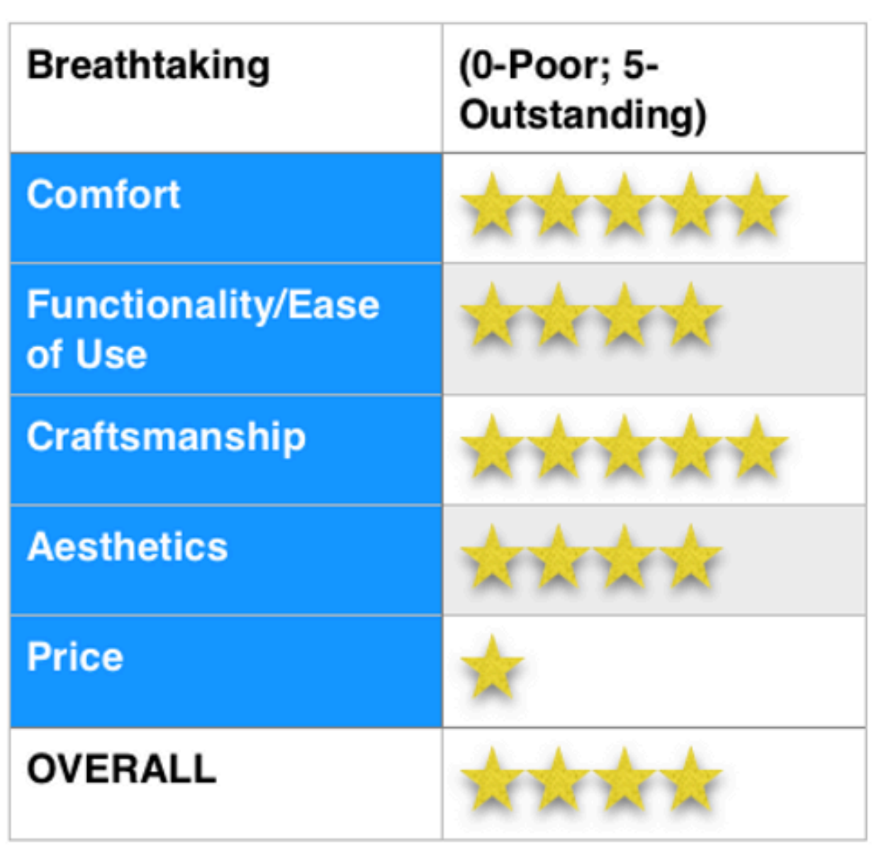
BREATHTAKING STRAP LITHE

We put this product under the "harness" category simply because it wraps around one side of the body. That being said, we couldn't really categorize this as a harness or a neck strap. The two parts work both independently and together to create one of the most comfortable tests of the group. "The **Breathtaking** Lithe Premium is made of 2 kinds of carefully selected leather; using specially adjusted sewing method, each leather's unique feature is best utilized. As a result, Lithe Premium fits the body better and minimizes the stress caused by the weight of the instrument. As soon as you put it on, you will appreciate not only the superior fit, but also enjoy the wonderful sound quality it helps to create. With use, the color of the leather changes to a deeper and glossier tone."-Breathtaking

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"There is something about this product. I don't know what it is but there is something different about this strap/harness...whatever that just makes the horn feel better." "I can see the need for a proper fit. I am right at the medium/large size change...I liked it in a large, but loved it in a medium!:" "What is this thing? I love it...just does the job so well." "The materials used are off the charts! Just wonderful craftsmanship!" "This isn't a typical harness, it does touch our side on the left but does not constrict breathing."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"Price! North of $200?" "Wow $200 bucks?!? I loved the way it felt but its not that important for me that I will spend that much." "I am going to have to say price is a con...but it worked so well and I have had such bad neck pain that I would see this as an investment worth making...but price is high."*

PRICE: Approx. $190-220



Breathtaking	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★★
Aesthetics	★★★★
Price	★
OVERALL	★★★★

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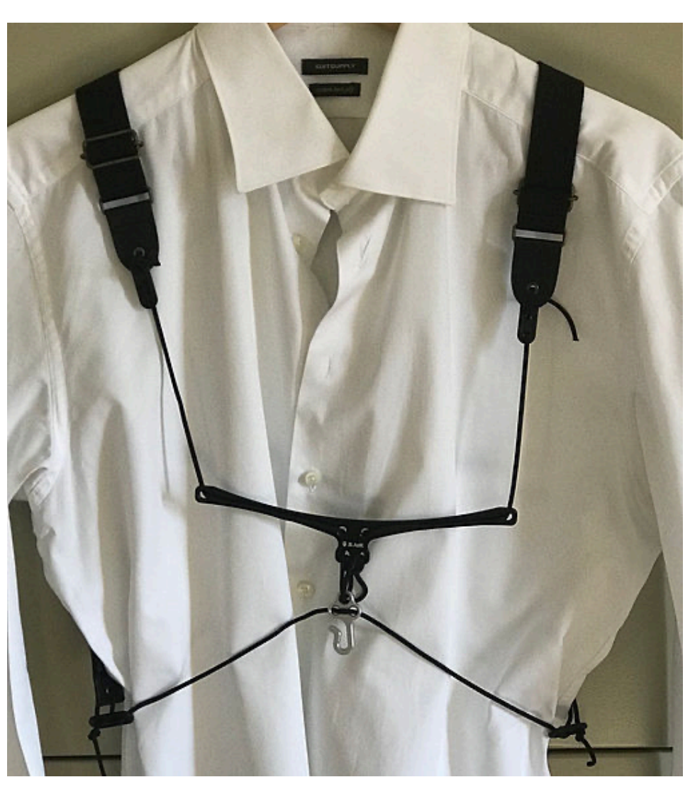


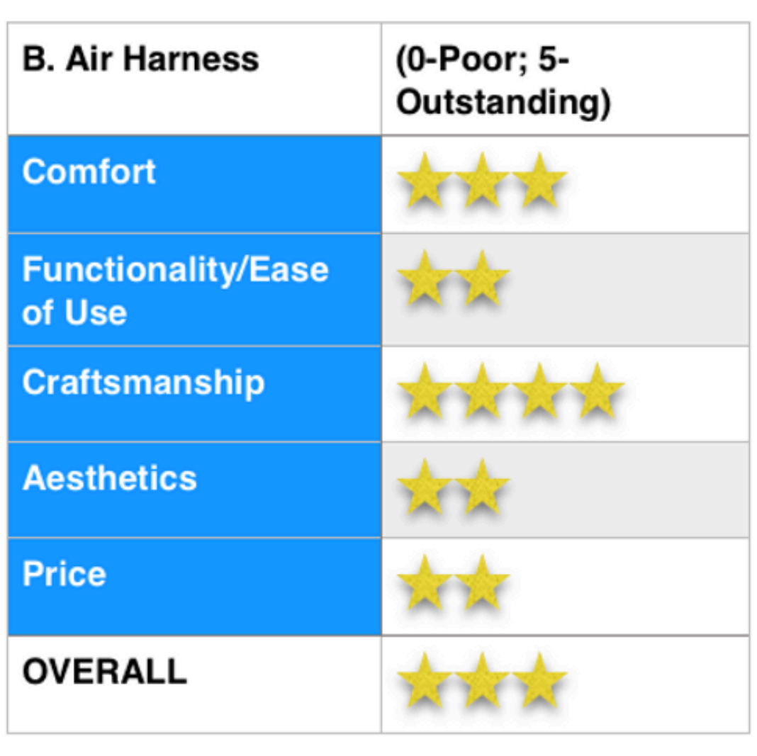
B.AIR HARNESS

For those who need a harness but desire the yolk construction of the B.Air "Bird Strap" there is the B.Air Harness. Using paracord, stretchy webbing and cotton webbing, the saxophonist can get the best of the B.Air Strap and the weight relief of a harness.

POSITIVE FEEDBACK: *"It allows you to breathe quite easily. It is comfortable." "The webbing and leather is all good quality." "Appears to be made to a very high standard." "There are a few out there that are cheaper but not many that will allow you to breathe as well." "I love the brass clasp and the metal adjuster is something you can count on to last."*

CONCERNS OR CRITICISMS: *"It's like a jigsaw puzzle to put on." "Too much stretch for me." "This harness just doesn't feel right. When I had my baritone on, I felt as if the harness was going to slip off my shoulders." "Pretty pricey."*

PRICE: Approx. $125



B. Air Harness	(0-Poor; 5-Outstanding)
Comfort	★★★
Functionality/Ease of Use	★★
Craftsmanship	★★★★
Aesthetics	★★
Price	★★
OVERALL	★★★

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